The Bilal Morning

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 BACKFILLED EDITION 12 stories · 15 sources

3 source articles could not be read today; those stories show headlines and links only.

THREE THINGS TO KNOW

1. SpaceX resumed Falcon 9 Starlink launches after a three-week hiatus by sending 27 satellites into orbit.
2. Russian satellites chasing a Ukraine-linked spacecraft have raised concerns among scientists regarding space warfare.
3. Astronomers discovered that ultra-hot Jupiter WASP-189b shares chemical similarities with its host star.

SpaceX Resumes Falcon 9 Starlink Launches After Three-Week Hiatus

A Falcon 9 rocket launched 27 Starlink internet satellites into orbit from California, marking the rocket's first Starlink mission in over three weeks.

- SpaceX launched 27 Starlink satellites into low Earth orbit from Vandenberg Space Force Base in California. [space.com]
  > "The company sent 27 of its Starlink internet satellites to low Earth orbit (LEO) today (Oct. 12)"
- The flight ended an unusually long break for Falcon 9 Starlink launches, which had not flown since September 19. [space.com]
  > "It was the first Starlink mission for a Falcon 9 since Sept. 19, which was another 27-satellite liftoff from Vandenberg."
- The mission marked the 20th successful flight and recovery for the Falcon 9 first-stage booster. [space.com]
  > "It was the 20th launch and landing for this particular booster, which is designated B1088."
- SpaceX eventually plans to replace the Falcon 9 fleet with its fully reusable Starship vehicle. [space.com]
  > "SpaceX plans to sunset the Falcon 9 and its cousin, the Falcon Heavy, in the next few years"

In the image: The photograph captures the Falcon 9 ascending past the ground launch tower into a twilight sky with a bright pillar of engine exhaust.

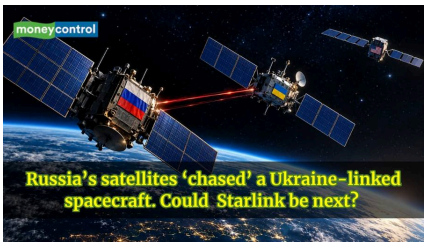
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space.com

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SPACE EXPLORATION



Russia's Satellites Chase Ukraine-Linked Spacecraft

Scientists raise concerns about potential space warfare after Russian satellites chase a Ukraine-linked spacecraft, sparking questions about Starlink's security.

- Russian satellites pursued a spacecraft linked to Ukraine, prompting scientists to raise concerns regarding space warfare. [moneycontrol.com]

> “Russia satellites "chased" a Ukraine-linked spacecraft. Could Elon Musk's Starlink be next? Scientists raised concerns on space wars”

In the image: The image illustrates two satellites featuring Russian and Ukrainian flags in orbit above Earth, with red laser-like beams connecting them, accompanied by a third satellite in the upper right.

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moneycontrol.com

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SpaceX Falcon 9 Launch Creates Dazzling 'Space Jellyfish' Over East Coast

An early morning SpaceX rocket launch from Florida produced a stunning 'space jellyfish' phenomenon visible to astonished observers across the United States East Coast.

- A SpaceX Falcon 9 rocket lifted off from Cape Canaveral Space Force Station carrying a commercial resupply mission to the International Space Station. [space.com] [wdbo.com][koco.com]

> “carrying a cargo variant of SpaceX's Dragon spacecraft on the company's 35th commercial resupply mission to the International Space Station”

- The glowing jellyfish appearance happens when exhaust plumes from dawn or dusk launches are brightly illuminated by the rising or setting sun. [space.com][wdbo.com][koco.com]

> “A jellyfish happens near sunrise or sunset when the exhaust plume from the rocket becomes brightly illuminated, creating a glowing shape resembling a jellyfish”

- Observers across various states witnessed the glowing plume, with one spectator initially mistaking the breathtaking display for a comet or potential disaster. [space.com]

> “My mind jumped between two thoughts: that is just beautiful beyond belief, and it is the end of the world.”

In the image: The image captures the glowing plume's distinctive, sprawling arc expanding across the dark dawn sky over a landscape, illustrating the dramatic visual spectacle mentioned in the text.

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space.com · wftv.com · wdbo.com · koco.com

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Varda Space Industries Operates Two Spacecraft in Orbit

Varda Space Industries is currently operating two spacecraft in orbit, with plans for multiple additional launches and fleet scaling over the coming years.

- Varda Space Industries successfully launched two refrigerator-sized spacecraft on October 1. [space.com]

  > “successfully launched its latest two refrigerator-sized spacecraft aboard SpaceX's Transporter-18 rideshare mission on Oct. 1”

- Varda CEO Will Bruey highlighted that launching multiple commercial reentry vehicles simultaneously is a first for humanity. [space.com]

  > “It's humanity's first time launching multiple commercial reentry vehicles simultaneously”

- The company plans to launch another vehicle later this month, with all three expected to land before Christmas. [space.com]

  > “Another Varda vehicle is scheduled to follow them into space later this month.”

- Varda recently raised $251 million in funding and aims to hire 100 people by the end of 2027. [space.com]

  > “In September, Varda announced it had raised $251 million in 'Series D' investment funding and will be hiring 100 people by the end of 2027”

In the image: The image shows engineers in cleanroom gear posing with spacecraft components, which is not mentioned in the text.

✓ 4 of 4 claims verified against sources
· 1 source

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Celebrating the Discovery Anniversary of the Whirlpool Galaxy

On October 13, 1773, astronomer Charles Messier discovered the Whirlpool Galaxy, though its true spiral structure and galactic nature were not understood at the time.

- French astronomer Charles Messier discovered the Whirlpool Galaxy on October 13, 1773. [space.com]

  > “On Oct. 13, 1773, a French astronomer named Charles Messier discovered the "Whirlpool Galaxy,"”

- Messier catalogued the object as part of his work to help comet hunters avoid confusion. [space.com]

  > “Charles Messier was scanning the sky for objects that could confuse comet hunters”

- At the time of discovery, Messier could not see the spiral structure and did not identify it as a galaxy. [space.com]

  > “Messier wasn't able to see the spiral structure, and he didn't identify it as a galaxy.”

- Seventy-two years later, William Parsons observed the whirlpool shape and identified it as a spiral nebula. [space.com]

  > “another astronomer named William Parsons saw the whirlpool shape, but he thought it was a spiral nebula.”

In the image: The image reveals the detailed grand design spiral arms of the Whirlpool Galaxy and its smaller companion galaxy NGC 5195, which are not described in detail by the historical text.

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Distant Planet Confirms Long-Held Assumption About Planet Formation

Astronomers discovered that ultra-hot Jupiter WASP-189b shares a chemical similarity with its host star, validating planet formation theories.

- WASP-189b is a scorching-hot planet located nearly 320 light-years away in the Libra constellation. [sciencedaily.com]

  > “Located nearly 320 light-years away in the Libra constellation, WASP-189b belongs to an extreme category of planets called ultra-hot Jupiters”

- Researchers measured gaseous magnesium and silicon simultaneously in an exoplanet's atmosphere for the first time. [sciencedaily.com]

  > “The breakthrough came from the first simultaneous measurement of gaseous magnesium and silicon in an exoplanet's atmosphere”

- The proportion of magnesium to silicon on WASP-189b closely matches the ratio found in its parent star. [sciencedaily.com]

  > “Their observations revealed that the proportion of magnesium to silicon on WASP-189b closely matches the ratio found in its parent star.”

- The research was led by Jorge Antonio Sanchez using the Immersion GRating INfrared Spectrograph on the Gemini South telescope. [sciencedaily.com]

> “An international research team led by Jorge Antonio Sanchez, a graduate student at Arizona State University (ASU), investigated WASP-189b with the high-resolution Immersion GRating INfrared Spectrograph (IGRINS).”

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sciencedaily.com

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CHIME Telescope Detects Early Universe Hydrogen Glow

Researchers have discovered that the CHIME project can independently detect faint hydrogen radio emissions from the early universe, offering a new path to studying dark energy.

- Dark energy is the mysterious force responsible for the accelerating expansion of the universe and accounts for 68% of its matter-energy budget. [space.com]

  > “Dark energy is the mysterious force that is accelerating the expansion of the universe.”

- The CHIME telescope project has demonstrated the ability to map the radio glow of hydrogen independently without relying on external galaxy survey data. [space.com]

  > “CHIME has now shown it can map the radio glow of hydrogen all on its own.”

- Using observations from 2019, researchers successfully detected a hydrogen signal from a time when the universe was approximately 5 billion years old. [space.com]

  > “they detected a hydrogen signal from when the universe was just 5 billion years old.”

In the image: The image illustrates radio telescope structures with a bright cosmic light source and superimposed wave patterns, visualizing hydrogen radio emission mapping.

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space.com

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Daily Astrology News Alert, 13 October 2026: Scorpio Moon and Sun-Uranus Tension Could Trigger a Sudden Change of Heart, Plan or Relationship Dynamic

timesofindia.indiatimes.com

You engaged with 5 of 8 Astronomy and astrophysics stories you saw

Pakistani forces kill two civilians in Balochistan, rights groups allege

Human rights organizations have condemned the extrajudicial killings of two civilians by Pakistani forces in Balochistan and demanded an independent investigation.

- Pakistani Coast Guard personnel shot and killed a 28-year-old driver named Balakh Sher in the Winder region. [prokerala.com]

  > "Balakh Sher was killed in the Winder region of Balochistan on October 11 after Pakistan's Coast Guard personnel opened fire on him."

- The Baloch Yakjehti Committee demanded an independent, impartial, and transparent investigation into the killing of Balakh Sher. [prokerala.com]

  > "called for an independent, impartial, and transparent investigation into the killing, while urging that those responsible be held accountable."

- The body of 28-year-old laborer Muhammad Iqbal was found dumped in the Barkhan region following what is alleged to be a fake encounter. [prokerala.com]

  > "the dead body of 28-year-old labourer Muhammad Iqbal was dumped in the Barkhan region on October 10, following a fake encounter."

- Muhammad Iqbal had been forcibly disappeared on December 26, 2025, by Pakistani Military Intelligence. [prokerala.com]

  > "Iqbal was forcibly disappeared on December 26, 2025, by Pakistani Military Intelligence in front of the Sessions Court in Barkhan."

- The Baloch Voice for Justice called on national authorities, the United Nations, and international organizations to address these violations. [prokerala.com]

  > "National authorities, the United Nations, and international human rights organisations must take urgent action to address enforced disappearances and extrajudicial executions in Balochistan."

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prokerala.com

You engaged with 1 of 4 Pakistan cricket team stories you saw

2 Pakistan army pilots killed as training aircraft crashes near Balochistan's Quetta

timesofindia.indiatimes.com

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Defold Game Engine Officially Adds Xbox Support in Version 1.14.0

The Defold game engine now officially supports Xbox, completing its coverage across all three major gaming consoles for approved developers.

- Defold version 1.14.0 officially introduces free support for Xbox development.
  [windowscentral.com]
  > “Defold 1.14.0 officially adds Xbox support, giving approved developers another free engine option.”
- The game engine was originally created by King, the studio behind Candy Crush. [windowscentral.com]
  > “Defold is a game engine originally created by King, the studio behind Candy Crush”
- Developers must be approved through programs like ID@Xbox to access Xbox development resources. [windowscentral.com]
  > “Developers must first be approved for Xbox console development through programs like ID@Xbox before they can access the specific resources.”
- The addition of Xbox support allows the engine to support all three major console platforms.
  [windowscentral.com]
  > “This completes a major expansion of the engine’s console capabilities, meaning it now supports all three major platforms.”

In the image: The image visually represents Defold supporting the three major gaming console platforms: PlayStation, Nintendo Switch, and Xbox.

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windowscentral.com

Exploring: a Video games story outside your usual topics, to learn whether you want more



New Manchester Christian Church Celebrates 150 Years in Hancock County

The Hancock County church is celebrating its 150th anniversary this month, honoring multi-generational families and a long history of community support.

- The New Manchester Christian Church is celebrating its 150th anniversary this month. [wtov9.com]

  > “New Manchester Christian Church marks 150 years of faith in Hancock County”

- Wanda Yantz, 91, is part of a family that has attended the church for five generations. [wtov9.com]

  > “Some families have attended the church for five generations, including 91-year-old Wanda Yantz”

- The church historically served as a support system when local mills closed. [wtov9.com]

  > “The church was always there to support everybody”

- Members are currently raising funds with a small wheelbarrow, inspired by a 1964 pastor's trek. [wtov9.com]

  > “So, we’ve been doing a fundraiser ourselves now, where we have a little wheelbarrow outside”

- A concluding Celebration Sunday is scheduled for October 18 following regular services. [wtov9.com]

  > “the New Manchester Christian Church will host a Celebration Sunday on Oct. 18 after its regular church service”

In the image: The image shows the white exterior building of the New Manchester Christian Church with a steeple, a small sign, and a grassy front lawn.

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wtov9.com

Exploring: a Religion story outside your usual topics, to learn whether you want more

You're caught up.

That's today's paper. Your next edition arrives tomorrow morning.